

there for posterity. Everything on a chain is time-stamped, thus making the chain as permanent and secure as records could ever be.

3) Almost in real time

Traditional methods of data collection and sharing are long and tedious. They involve risk mitigators who evaluate the data before clearing it. And this comes at a cost as well as it makes the entire procedure lengthy. Blockchains will help eliminate the need for an intermediary resource. Plus, with the inclusion of smart contracts into the ledgers, members can also safeguard transactions that are created using mutual and secure consensus on the network.

Putting it into action

When you think about any of the branches of government, whether its federal, local or state, you picture overflowing cabinets of paperwork. Things changed when most records became digitised. While that hasn't been a total success in India as yet, we know we are getting there slowly and steadily. Nonetheless, these digitised records were not utilised until the internet came along in its current form. The internet as we know it today has helped make public sector records more accessible and transparent. With the application of blockchain, these records can be better maintained and become even more useful to both the government and the taxpayer. The taxpayer can now be in control of what information the governing bodies has on them, and also control the access for the same. The official agencies, on the other hand, can reduce their own burden by having an auditable paper trail that is time stamped and immutable. It can also help them trace any deviations. For instance, tax defaulters will stick out like a sore thumb when they try to evade their tax payments.

Blockchain enabled e-Voting (BEV)

Elections are a trying time for governing bodies and voters alike. For decades now, we have all dealt with the chaos of standing in a long winding queue for hours to cast our vote. While our nation is striving to become 'digital' in the true sense of the term, not much has changed as far as our voting systems go. Things get even worse as you move towards the rural areas. There have been talks for a while about making the whole voting system electronic. This would mean that a voter could vote from either a physical booth using an Electronic Voting Machine (EVM) or via their mobile phones/laptops.